Westbrook City Council

~ Regular Meeting ~

Date: Monday, June 1, 2026
Time: 6:00 PM
Location: Westbrook High School (Room 114), 125 Stroudwater St. (Hybrid via Zoom)
Video: https://vimeo.com/1197520485
Packet: https://www.westbrookmaine.gov/AgendaCenter/ViewFile/Agenda/_06012026-1008

Timestamps below are clickable [0:00]-style links — they jump straight to that moment in the video.

This summary highlights the meeting's key discussions and decisions, with direct quotes and timestamps for verification — it is not a substitute for watching the full meeting. *Summarization necessarily condenses and selects; for complete context, nuance, and anything not covered here, watch the full video at the link above. (Produced by: WestbrookCurrents.com)*

Unofficial summary. *This is produced by Westbrook Currents, an independent site — not the City of Westbrook — and may contain mistakes. For the official record, see the City's approved minutes and the meeting video.*

Mayor's Message, Council Messages & First Public Comment

Routine Items: Pride Month, Alewife Migration, Police Staffing & Upcoming Topics [5:52]

Discussion Summary

Mayor Morse proclaimed June 2026 as Pride Month in Westbrook, citing the 1969 Stonewall riots and the City's support for its LGBTQIA+ community. He announced the annual alewife migration from Casco Bay through Mill Brook began the previous week, with the Presumpscot Regional Land Trust hosting guided viewing walks (details at prlt.org) and a request to keep people and pets out of the cordoned-off fish-viewing pools.

He authorized a temporary increase in authorized police staffing from 48 to 49 officers, effective July 2026, ahead of Captain David Thompson's September retirement — allowing a replacement hire to start the police academy this summer rather than leaving a staffing gap; authorized staffing returns to 48 once Thompson retires.

Director of Planning and Code Enforcement Rebecca Spitella will repeat her recent Planning Board presentation on residential growth trends for the full Council on June 15, and separately for the School Committee; the Mayor has directed staff to prepare data for a broader discussion later this year on a potential school impact fee. Public Safety Committee Chair Amy Faulkingham will chair a July 6 committee meeting on the City's current blanket ban on motorized scooters on public streets, to consider a repeal or revision.

Key Decisions

✓ Informational — no vote taken.

Action Items

None.

Tribute to Retiring City Administrator Jerry Bryant [5:53]

Discussion Summary

Mayor Morse devoted an extended, emotional tribute to City Administrator Jerre “Jerry” Bryant's final Council meeting after more than 23 years in the role, presenting him with a ceremonial key to the city. Bryant, replying at age 72, reflected on his tenure with visible emotion, crediting the City's various mayors and councils for prioritizing the City's interests over personal disagreements.

Every councilor present — Rairdon, Chau, Turcotte, and Shaughnessy — followed with personal tributes during Council Messages, recalling specific memories of Bryant mentoring them as new councilors. First Public Comment continued in the same vein: Assistant City Administrator Jenny Franceschi read a letter from Bryant's high school (Oxford Hills Comprehensive, class of 1972, football standout) honoring his career; Brendan Riley (10 Alberta Dr.), who served on the committee that hired Bryant, called it “the best decision we ever made”; Chris Dudley (18 Haskell St.) and Sue Joyce also offered thanks.

Key Decisions

✓ Informational — no vote taken.

Action Items

None.

Orders of the Day — Second & Final Reading

Orders 2026-61, -62, -64 — Davan Pool, FD Donation & Trail Blazes Funding (Consent) [30:50]

Discussion Summary

All three first-read at the May 18, 2026 meeting: confirmation of the $8,348.30 Davan Indoor Pool emergency motor-repair expenditure, acceptance of a $5,000 Enbridge/American Online Giving Foundation donation plus a $6,850 Fire Department supply hose purchase, and $30,000 in Recreation & Conservation Commission funding for Westbrook Trail Blazes trail-grooming equipment — see that meeting's summary for full detail.

Key Decisions

✓ Passed together by unanimous roll call, 6–0.

Action Items

None.

Order 2026-63 — Pyxis Medication-Storage Rental Agreement (Separated for Discussion) [32:50]

Found on page 25 of the packet.

Discussion Summary

Councilor Rairdon asked that this item — first read May 18 as part of a larger batch — be considered separately. City Administrator Holmes disclosed a last-minute complication: the vendor (CareFusion Solutions) had previously indicated the five-year rental could be converted mid-agreement to an outright purchase, but sent an email during the meeting itself retracting that assurance. Holmes said the Administration still recommended proceeding with the rental as presented, while noting the Council could table the item for further vendor discussion if it preferred.

Councilor Chau asked that staff monitor the balance of opioid settlement funds (the item's funding source) to ensure a quick pivot if those funds run low before the rental's five-year term ends. The Council proceeded without tabling.

Key Decisions

✓ Passed by unanimous roll call, 6–0.

Action Items

None.

New Business — Business License

Happy Wheels Skate Center — Liquor License (Public Hearing) [35:07]

Found on page 45 of the packet. Public hearing held; no opposition.

Discussion Summary

Following a public hearing with no opposition, the Council approved a State Liquor License for Happy Wheels Skate Center (84 Warren Ave., Unit K), allowing the four-year-old, family-owned rink to add beer and wine service. Co-owner Taylor (with husband Derek Fitzgerald) noted the license had been asked about since the business opened. Mayor Morse and Councilor Chau both praised the rink's "Kids Skate Free Club" affordable-access program and its popular school skate nights.

Key Decisions

✓ Passed by unanimous roll call, 6–0.

Action Items

None.

New Business — Orders (One Reading Required)

Order 2026-65 — Annual Vendor List Amendment [39:07]

Found on page 57 of the packet.

Discussion Summary

Amends the FY2025–2026 Annual Vendor List to add Northern Light Wellbeing, LLC (dba Work Health) as an approved vendor for occupational health services (physicals, injury evaluations, return-to-work assessments) for the Fire, Police, and Dispatch departments, alongside existing vendor Concentra Occupational Health, given rising demand for these services.

Key Decisions

✓ Passed by unanimous roll call, 6–0.

Action Items

None.

Order 2026-66 — Data Center Moratorium Ordinance [41:12]

Found on page 59 of the packet.

Discussion Summary

Enacts a 180-day moratorium on siting, permitting, construction, or operation of any data center in Westbrook, giving staff time to review the Land Use Ordinance's current data-center provisions (which today only permit the use within the Rock Row contract zone).

Councilor Turcotte asked what prompted this. Mayor Morse explained that after Governor Mills vetoed a statewide data-center moratorium (LD 307), state legislators urged municipalities to consider their own local moratoriums; around the same time, Westbrook learned that neighboring Scarborough had received an actual data-center application, prompting the City to get its own policy in order before any proposal arrives here. No data center has been formally proposed in Westbrook.

Councilor Chau asked whether a data center could open simply because it isn't explicitly addressed in the ordinance; City Administrator Holmes and Director Spitella confirmed that outside the Rock Row contract zone, data centers are not currently a permitted use anywhere in the City. Councilor Turcotte asked that any draft ordinance language be reviewed by both the City's attorney and someone with IT/information-security expertise. Discussion confirmed the moratorium's focus is the impact of large-scale data centers on local electrical and water utility capacity, not data/privacy concerns; Councilor Chau separately noted, as an aside, an emerging trend of small-scale compute/battery units being installed in private homes as a related but distinct phenomenon worth future awareness.

Key Decisions

✓ Passed by unanimous roll call, 6–0.

Action Items

None.

Second Public Comment

Community Shout-Out & Together Days Volunteer Call [50:26]

Discussion Summary

A speaker (name not clearly stated on the record) thanked retired Public Services deputy Artie Ledoux for donating $300 in gift cards to the Westbrook Community Center's Wednesday bingo program, and reminded residents that Westbrook Together Days (Friday–Saturday) still needs volunteers, directing interested residents to the event's Facebook page or the Community Center front desk.

Key Decisions

✓ Informational — no vote taken.

Action Items

None.

Referrals & Closing

Data Center Definitions Referral, Committee Reports & Adjournment [52:20]

Discussion Summary

A request to refer review of Data Center definitions and regulations in the Land Use Ordinance to the Planning Board was approved by show of hands. No committee report updates and no executive session. Meeting adjourned by show of hands.

Key Decisions

✓ Referral approved by show of hands.

✓ Motion to adjourn approved by show of hands.

Action Items

None.

How this was made

This summary was produced from the meeting video (linked above, hosted on the City's Vimeo showcase). The audio was transcribed with AI-assisted speech-to-text and speaker identification. This process cross-checked names and figures against the official packet and the city council roster, attributed speakers from context (introductions, roll-call order, direct address by the presiding officer) rather than the raw diarization labels alone, and drafted this summary and the quoted excerpts. Quotes are lightly cleaned of filler words/false starts but not reworded. Review tier: Not reviewed.

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